



Seagate launches world's first 6 Gbps SATA hard drive, the Barracuda XT



Sony Ericsson's MH907 headsets automatically play when worn, and pause when one earbud is removed

Epson Stylus TX550W

For those not willing to spend the least.

In the world of multi-functionality devices, probably one of the best marriages of two individual devices have to be the printer and the scanner. The Epson Stylus TX550W represents the latest breed of such MFDs. The device looks a lot like 'office furniture' due to its black colored plasticky body. Its not very heavy to carry around, but has somewhat large dimensions as compared to competitor models. To point out some of its USPs, it has a adequately-sized 2.5-inch LCD screen that tilts to an easily viewable angle. It also accepts multi-format memory cards. Other than the typical USB connectivity, you also have wireless connectivity. This will make it very easy to use this MFD with portable devices such as laptops.

The bundled software makes configuration over wireless very simple. After printing a variety of test pages in the



economy mode, we think that pages appear too faint. While they appear pretty decent in quality under normal mode. Under high quality, the photo prints came out fairly well. Colors seemed natural and the level of detail was pretty good. Scanning an image revealed that the image quality, although slightly washed out, is pretty decent overall.

At Rs. 9000, the TX550W is on par with the HP Photosmart C4588 MFD in terms of price. This model is quite easy to use, delivers decent results and has nifty features like the LCD screen and Wi-Fi. If you're looking for an MFD under the 10k range, the TX550W can definitely be considered worth buying.

Contact

Epson India

Phone: +91-80-30515000

Email: think@eid.epson.co.in

Web-site: www.epson.co.in

Price: Rs. 8,999

Specifications

Printing Method: On-demand ink jet (Piezoelectric)

Maximum resolution: 5760 x 1440 dpi

Scanner type: A4 Flatbed Colour Image Scanner, CIS type sensor, 2400 x 2400 dpi resolution

Display: 2.5 TFT Colour LCD

Memory card slots: CF Type II, Memory Stick, SD/MMC, xD-Picture Card

Interface: USB 2.0, Ethernet, Wi-Fi 802.11b/g

RATINGS

Features	7.5
Performance	7
Build quality	6
Value for money	6.5
Overall	7

Contact

Samsung India Electronics Pvt Ltd.

Phone: +91-22-41511234

Email:

kunal.a@samsung.com

Web site: www.samsungmobile.com

Price: Rs. 7,030

Specifications

Band: Quad band GSM

Dimensions: 113 x 48.9 x 17.4 mm

Display: 120 x 160 pixels, 1.77-inch, 256K Colors TFT

Connectivity: EDGE, Bluetooth 2.1 with A2DP, USB

Camera: 1.3 mega-pixel

RATINGS

Features	6
Performance	7
Build quality	8
Value for money	7
Overall	7

Samsung Marine

Tough nut to crack

The Samsung B2100 Marine is a tough phone with a spartan feature set. A completely rubberised body gives a feeling of solidity and grip. The back panel stays in place thanks to a circular lock and can't be easily pulled out like most phones.

The buttons, aside from being slightly hard to press, have a tactile feel. At just over a 100 grams, the phone is quite light-weight. The phone conforms to the IP57 industry standard for robustness and is water, dust and shock resistant. Overall, the phone does feel as tough as it is advertised.

While the meager feature set is acceptable, some of the

inferior components used in the phone are a put-off. The B2100 has a low resolution display that's low for our liking. It has unsatisfying sunlight legibility and the camera is pretty bad. It uses a yesteryear 1.3 mega-pixel sensor. The on board torch is pretty powerful for a phone. The 1000 mAh battery gives a pretty decent up-time.

During calls, there were problems of not proper transmission of audio. Other than that, the network reception was pretty decent. At Rs. 7,030, the phone is a little overpriced. The fact that it does not have modern-day features like GPS or a fitness application will probably not



entice the elite adventurer. But for people who have a habit of dropping their phone by mistake and damaging it, this might be for you.